MIL-F-45955A(AL)
5 June 1985
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-45955(WC)
7 February 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FLOW TEST MACHINE, RADIATOR

This specification is approved for use by the US Army Armament Research and Development Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of The Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a radiator flow test machine designed for testing all types of automotive radiators.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications, standards, and handbooks of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

O-A-548	-	Antifreeze/Coolant, Engine: Ethylene Glycol, Inhibited, Concentrated.
W-C-596	-	Connector, Electrical, Power, General Specification for.
W-C-596/13	-	Connector, Plug, Electrical, General Purpose, Hospital Grade, Grounding, 2 Pole, 3 Wire, 15 Amperes, 125 Volts, 50/60 Hertz.
CC-M-1807	-	Motors, Alternating Current, Fractional and Integral Horsepower (500 HP and Smaller).
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Center, ATTN: SMCAR-ETS (R), Rock Island, IL 61299-7300 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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PPP-B-665 - Box, Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-C-843 - Cushioning Material, Cellulosic.
PPP-T-60 - Tape, Packaging, Waterproof.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-B-121 - Barrier Material, Greaseproofed, Waterproofed, Flexible.
MIL-T-152 - Treatment, Moisture and Fungus-Resistant, of Communications, Electronic, and Associated Electrical Equipment.
MIL-V-173 - Varnish, Moisture-and-Fungus-Resistant (For Treatment of Communications, Electronic, and Associated Equipment).
MIL-C-5501 - Caps and Plugs, Protective, Dust and Moisture Seal, General Specification for.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-H28 - Screw-Thread Standards for Federal Services.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130 - Identification Marking of US Military Property.
MIL-STD-889 - Dissimilar Metals.
MIL-STD-1186 - Cushioning, Anchoring, Bracing, Blocking and Waterproofing; with Appropriate Test Methods.

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

US DEPARTMENT OF LABOR

OSHA 2206 - General Industry, OSHA Safety and Health Standards (29 CFR 1910).

(Copies of specifications, standards, handbooks, drawings, and publications required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document(s) form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. The issues of the documents which are indicated as DoD adopted shall be the issue listed in the current DoDISS and the supplement thereto, if applicable.

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM D3951-82 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging.
ASTM E380-84 - Standard for Metric Practice.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

NATIONAL FIRE PROTECTION ASSOCIATION (NFPA)

NFPA 70 - National Electrical Code.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Fire Protection Association, Batterymarch Park, Quincy, MA 02269.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2.1), the contractor shall furnish one or more flow test machines for first article inspection. The first article may be either a preproduction model or an initial production item which conforms to the requirements of this specification. In either case, the approved first article and the production items shall be identical and in accordance with the terms of the contract. Approval of the first article shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility to furnish equipment in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Design. The flow test machine shall be new and of the manufacturer's current design meeting the performance requirements specified herein. The test machine shall be designed to comply with the maximum loads and capacities with an adequate factor for safety, working efficiency, and minimum wear.

3.2.1 Safety and health requirements. The flow test machine shall comply with the general safety and health requirements promulgated under OSHA 2206 that are applicable to the machine itself. Exceptions and additional requirements for safety and health shall be as specified in the contract (see 6.2.1 and 6.4).

3.2.2 Threads. Threads shall conform to FED-STD-H28 and the applicable Detailed Standard section referenced therein.

3.2.3 Corrosion resistance. The flow test machine shall be designed so that all exposed metal (see 6.5.1) and working surfaces are made of corrosion-resistant materials or are coated or covered with a protective finish that shall provide corrosion protection (see 3.7.3 and 3.8).

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3.2.4 Measurement system. The US Customary System of Units (US) or the International System of Units (SI) may be used in the design and construction of the machine. In this specification, all measurements, dimensions, sizes and capacities are given in the US system. These measurements may be converted to the SI system by using the conversion factors and methods specified in ASTM E380-84.

3.2.5 Measuring and indicating devices. When specified (see 6.2.1), measuring and indicating devices shall be graduated in both the US and SI systems of measurement. When a dual US and SI system is furnished, dials shall have independent zero adjustments and shall be calibrated so that the last dial graduation progresses into, and is continuous with, the first dial graduation as the dial is rotated through the zero position. When only one system of graduation is acceptable, the particular graduation required shall be as specified (see 6.2.1). Regardless of the measurement system used, all measuring and indicating devices on the machine shall be graduated in the same system.

3.3 Material. Materials not specifically designated herein or in the contract shall be of a quality commensurate with commercial practice within the producing industry, shall be suitable for the intended purpose in the design of the end item, and shall meet all requirements specified herein. Materials shall be free from defects which would adversely affect the performance or maintainability of the individual components or the overall assembly. When dissimilar metals are used in contact with each other, suitable protection against galvanic corrosion shall be applied in accordance with MIL-STD-889.

3.3.1 Reclaimed materials. The contractor is encouraged to use reclaimed materials for fabricating new parts without jeopardizing the chemical and physical properties, design integrity, and intent of the materials originally selected or specified. The reclaimed materials shall have been reprocessed, remanufactured, or recycled in a manner that shall restore them to the same chemical composition and physical properties as the materials originally selected for use. It shall not be permissible to use reclaimed parts as is, or rebuilt from scrap or other used equipment.

3.4 Construction. The flow test machine shall be furnished complete so it can be used for the operations specified herein. Parts used in fabricating the machine shall be new and free of defects. Part surfaces shall be clean and free of extraneous materials. External surfaces shall be smooth and free of sharp edges. Functional surfaces shall be free from burrs and defects affecting performance.

3.4.1 Fastening devices. Screws, pins, bolts, and similar parts shall be installed with means for preventing loss of tightness and adjustment. The methods for preventing loss of tightness or adjustment shall be in accordance with accepted engineering standards and practice. All such parts when subject to removal or adjustment shall not be swaged, peened, staked, or otherwise deformed.

3.4.2 Welding, brazing, and soldering. Welding, brazing, and soldering shall be of a quality which shall sustain all requirements of the welded, brazed, or soldered parts. These operations shall not be employed as repair measures for defective parts.

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3.4.3 Castings and forgings. Castings shall be free from blowholes, porosity, hardspots, shrinkage defects, cracks or other defects. Forgings shall be free from scale, inclusions, cold shuts, mismatching, sharp edges, or other defects. Castings and forgings shall be free from any properties adversely affecting their strength, durability, or suitability. Reclaiming or repair of major castings and forgings shall be permitted if the repair is not on a critical surface.

3.4.4 Lubrication. All bearings (except sealed, permanently lubricated type), mating gears, and all other moving parts shall be provided means to assure adequate lubrication. Recirculating systems shall include filters which are cleanable or replaceable. Each lubricant reservoir shall have means for determining fluid levels. Oil holes, grease fittings, and filler caps shall be located to be accessible. The manufacturer shall include and install all lubricants, fluids, greases and other compounds in accordance with the best commercial practice of the producing industry (see 6.6). The lubrication systems shall be temporarily capped or stopped to prevent loss of lubricants during shipment. The manufacturer shall include a warning notice in the instruction manual and on the machine to remove the temporary caps and stoppers before start-up or use of the flow test machine.

3.4.5 Electrical connections. Connections to screw-type terminals shall be mechanically secured with means to prevent loss of tightness. All other electrical connections shall be mechanically secured and soldered or brazed. Only rosin base fluxes shall be used in all soldering operations.

3.4.6 Interchangeability. All parts shall be manufactured to definite standards, clearances, and tolerances in order that any such parts of a particular type or model may be replaced, interchanged, and adjusted without modification of the replacement parts or any other parts of the unit. When practical, all parts shall be permanently and legibly marked in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.5 Electrical components. Except as otherwise specified herein, electrical components, including wiring, shall conform to NFPA 70.

3.5.1 Motor. The electric motor shall be not less than one horsepower, squirrel-cage type, 115 volt, 60 Hz, and single phase in accordance with CC-M-1807. The motor shall have class B insulation.

3.5.2 Electrical power supply cable. An electrical power supply cable shall be installed on each machine. The electrical power supply cable shall be not less than 10 feet in length and shall terminate with a three prong grounding plug in accordance with W-C-596/13 and NFPA 70, as applicable. The electric power supply cable shall include sheathing/covering in accordance with NFPA 70. The cable shall have a voltage/potential and amphere/current carrying capacity exceeding that required by the electric power consuming devices, including electric motors, of the flow test machine in accordance with NFPA 70.

3.5.3 Fungus control. Components of electrical circuitry that are hermetically sealed or inherently resistant to fungus growth and moisture need not be treated. Components of electrical circuitry that are not inherently resistant to fungus growth or moisture shall be treated in accordance with MIL-T-152 and MIL-V-173.

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3.6 Performance. The flow test machine shall be capable of testing all types of commercial automotive-type (automobiles, medium and large trucks and heavy tractors) radiators within the capacities specified in 3.7.4 and 3.7.7. The machine shall incorporate provisions for holding the radiator, while the radiator is being tested, without danger to the operator, without damage to the radiator, and without damage to the flow test machine. The flow test machine shall also be designed to be portable so that radiators can be tested while mounted in the vehicle.

3.7 Components.

3.7.1 Body. The body or shell of the flow test machine shall be of rigid metal construction, with a reinforced structure throughout that shall provide resistance against twisting and bending. The body shall be capable of supporting one large tractor radiator, weighing 1,000 pounds, on the work rack and 60 gallons of water in the tank without deformation or leakage (see 3.7.3 and 3.7.4).

3.7.2 Casters. Portability shall be provided by means of swivel casters not less than four inches in diameter. There shall be a minimum of four casters which shall be capable of supporting a total load of no less than 1,500 pounds. Each caster shall include a locking device that shall prevent rotation of the wheel while the machine is in use.

3.7.3 Water tank. The water tank shall have a minimum capacity of 60 gallons, shall be leakproof, shall be designed to be accessible for cleaning, and shall be equipped with a drain hole and plug. The tank shall be painted with at least one coat of rust inhibiting paint (see 3.2.3 and 3.8).

3.7.4 Work rack. The work rack shall be no less than 80 inches long by 40 inches wide and capable of supporting a radiator, 60 inches long by 50 inches wide by 16 inches thick weighing 1000 pounds, without damage or permanent deformation.

3.7.5 Hoses. Input hoses shall be included with each machine. The hoses shall be of a diameter that shall accept the specified rate of flow (see 3.7.7) as measured at the radiator hose connection outlet. Two hoses, three feet in length, shall be furnished for testing radiators in the flow test machine and two hoses, eight feet in length, shall be furnished for on-vehicle testing of radiators. Corrosion resistant hose clamps shall be provided for each connection.

3.7.6 Pump. The pump, an integral part of the flow test machine, shall be capable of delivering water at 120 gallons per minute (gpm) continuously at 20 pounds per square inch gage (psig) differential pressure.

3.7.7 Test system. The test system shall be functionally complete. The system shall have a minimum flow range of 0 to 120 gpm, with infinite control within this range. A rate flow gage shall be an integral part of the system, with a minimum flow range of 0 to 150 gpm. The gage shall be accurate within three percent of full scale. The gage shall be graduated in five gpm increments, with every tenth gpm increment designated by an easily read numeral (see 3.2.5). The system shall contain a screen or filter to screen out contaminants in the water.

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3.8 Painting. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), painting and finishing shall be in accordance with the best commercial practice in the industry. Before painting, all surfaces shall be clean and be free of all foreign matter detrimental to painting. At least one coat of primer (or a phosphate or chromate base) and one coat of enamel, or equivalent (i.e., epoxy enamel), shall be applied.

3.9 Product identification. The flow test machine shall be marked for product identification in accordance with MIL-STD-130 and, unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), shall include the National Stock Number.

3.10 Workmanship. Standards of workmanship shall assure that the flow test machine shall have the stability, strength, safety, and efficient operating characteristics found in the best commercial units and as specified in Section 3.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

(a) First article inspection (see 4.3).
(b) Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be applied to the preproduction model or initial production item (see 3.1). Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), first article inspection shall consist of the examination in 4.5 and all tests under 4.6. Failure of the first article to pass the examination or any of the tests shall be cause for rejection.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), quality conformance inspection shall be applied to production items offered for acceptance under the contract. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), quality conformance inspection shall consist of (a) through (e) below. Failure of any item to pass an examination or test shall be cause for rejection of the item.

(a) Product examination (see 4.5).
(b) Pump test (see 4.6.1).
(c) Gage test (see 4.6.2).
(d) Capacity test (see 4.6.3).
(e) Packaging inspection (see 4.7).

4.4.1 Sampling. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), sampling for quality conformance inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using the following Inspection Levels and Acceptable Quality Levels (AQL):

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Inspection or Test	Inspection Level	AQL
Product examination (see 4.5)	II	1.0
Pump test (see 4.6.1)	II	1.0
Gage test (see 4.6.2)	II	1.0
Capacity test (see 4.6.3)	S-4	1.0
Packaging inspection (see 4.7)	S-4	4.0

4.5 Product examination. Visually and manually examine the flow test machine to determine conformance with the requirements of 3.2 through 3.3, 3.4 through 3.5.3, and 3.7 through 3.10. Visual examination shall include verification of completeness of manufacture and assembly, conformance to specified standards, adequacy of markings, proper cleaning, and freedom from defects. Manual examination shall include the operation of movable parts by hand to assure proper functioning. The examination provisions may be applied at the earliest practical point in manufacture at which it is feasible to inspect for acceptance without risk of change in the characteristic by subsequent operations. Failure of the contractor to provide objective evidence that the flow test machine passed the examinations prescribed for them by the contractor's inspection system shall be cause for rejection.

4.6 Tests.

4.6.1 Pump test. The pump shall be run continuously for 20 minutes at full capacity. At the end of that time, flow shall be measured and must equal or exceed 120 gpm at the radiator hose connection outlet. Flow rate shall be determined by measuring the time required to fill a container of known volume or by use of a flow meter. If a flow meter is used, it shall be of the totalizing recording type that is accurate within three percent of the measured value (see 3.7.6).

4.6.2 Gage test. The pump shall operate at indicated gage rates of 10, 30, 50, 70, 90, and 120 gpm for 30 seconds each. Flow rate shall be determined as specified in 4.6.1. The indicated flow rate must be within ± three percent of the actual rate for each of the six tests (see 3.7.7).

4.6.3 Capacity test. The water tank shall be loaded with a minimum of 60 gallons of water and a radiator or radiator mock-up weighing at least 1,000 pounds shall be mounted on the work rack. At the end of 15 minutes there shall be no evidence of damage, permanent deformation, or leakage (see 3.7.3 and 3.7.4).

4.7 Packaging inspection. Packaging inspection shall be conducted before and after packaging to determine compliance with the requirements of Section 5.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be Level A or Industrial. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), Industrial preservation shall be provided. When military (Level A) preservation is required, it shall be so specified in the contract.

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Cleaning and drying. Cleaning and drying of the flow test machine shall be in accordance with any applicable process and procedure of MIL-P-116.

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5.1.1.2 Preservation. Caster bearings and other functional surfaces shall be preserved with type P-11 preservative. Noncritical surfaces which are subject to corrosion (see 3.2.3) shall be preserved with type P-1 or type P-19 preservative. Preservatives and procedures for application shall conform to MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.2.1 Water system. Internal surfaces of the water system shall be flushed with a solution consisting of forty percent ethylene glycol conforming to O-A-548 and sixty percent clean water. After flushing, the system shall be thoroughly drained.

5.1.1.3 Unit packaging. The unit method of packaging shall conform to method I of MIL-P-116. Surfaces preserved with type P-11 preservative shall be covered with barrier material conforming to MIL-B-121, grade A. The tube metering float shall be removed from the meter gage and wrapped with the same barrier material. The meter gage and metering float shall be cushioned with material conforming to PPP-C-843. Secure cushioning and barrier material with tape conforming to PPP-T-60, type optional. The tube metering float shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-665, class 2. Coil the hose to a safe diameter and secure with cotton tape or twine. Water inlets and outlets shall be closed with plastic caps or plugs conforming to MIL-C-5501 or sealed with tape conforming to PPP-T-60, type IV.

5.1.1.3.1 Technical data. Technical data when furnished, shall be packaged in accordance with method IC-1 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.3.2 Unit container. The unit container for the flow test machine, accessories, and publications (when applicable) shall conform to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. Container closure shall be as specified in the container specification.

5.1.2 Industrial. Industrial preservation shall be as specified in ASTM D3951-82.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, Level B, or Industrial. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), Industrial packing shall be provided. When military (Levels A and B) packing is required, it shall be so specified in the contract.

5.2.1 Level A. Each flow test machine, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a box conforming to either PPP-B-601, overseas type, or PPP-B-621, class 2. Blocking, bracing, anchoring, and cushioning shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1186.

5.2.2 Level B. The flow test machines shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except the containers shall conform to either PPP-B-601, domestic type, or PPP-B-621, class 1.

5.2.3 Industrial. Industrial packing shall be as specified in ASTM D3951-82.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be Military or Industrial. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), Industrial marking shall be provided. When military marking is required, it shall be so specified in the contract.

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5.3.1 Military marking. Military marking shall be as specified in MIL-STD-129.

5.3.2 Industrial marking. Industrial marking shall be as specified in ASTM D3951-82.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The flow test machine covered by this specification is used to test the performance and cooling efficiency of automotive vehicle radiators.

6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) First article when required (see 3.1).
(c) Exceptions and additional safety/health requirements when required (see 3.2.1 and 6.4).
(d) Measuring and indicating device graduation(s) required (see 3.2.5).
(e) Painting and finishing if different (see 3.8).
(f) Product identification if different (see 3.9).
(g) First article inspection if different (see 4.3).
(h) Quality conformance inspection if different (see 4.4).
(i) Sampling if different (see 4.4.1).
(j) Level of preservation, packing, and marking if different (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).

6.3 Contract data requirements. Required technical data such as operator's manuals, parts lists, and other instructions for operation and maintenance, as identified on a numbered DD Form 1664, should be specified on a DD Form 1423 incorporated in the contract (see 6.3.1).

6.3.1 Repair part manuals. Repair part identification, in repair part manuals, shall include the prime contractor's name, nomenclature, part number, and price. Repair part identification shall also include the name of the original equipment/part manufacturer (OEM - actual part manufacturer), Federal Supply Code for Manufacturers (FSCM), nomenclature, part number, and price of the part immediately after the prime contractor's part identification. High mortality rate items shall be so identified as shown in MIL-M-7298.

6.4 Safety and health requirements. In order that equipment integrated into the user's operational environment will comply with OSHA limitations and control of noise levels, radiation, electromagnetic emission, noxious vapors, heat, etc., as applicable, specific requirements concerning such points of operation, and other health and safety requirements, should be specified by the user.

6.5 Definitions.

6.5.1 Exposed metal. Exposed metal is defined as metal exposed to atmospheric conditions, acids, solvents, anti-freeze solutions, and water.

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6.6 Standard lubricants. The machine manufacturer should specify and use to the maximum extent possible those lubricants (see 3.4.4) that are presently in the Department of Defense supply system. MIL-HDBK-113, MIL-HDBK-267, and MIL-STD-838 may be used as selection guides.

6.7 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

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1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-F-45953A	

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
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b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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